

Unlawful use

Hi,

Two months back, I installed Adobe Photoshop 7.0 (a 30-day evaluation version) on my system which has Windows XP, with no Internet connection.

After the trial period the software stopped working, so I re-installed the software using the Digit Mindware CD. Even then, I was unable to use it. I tried installing the same on a friend's PC with the same outcome: The software expired after 30 days and I was unable to use it anymore. I think that some data pertaining to the expiry date is saved in some part of the computer system. Kindly tell me where such data is stored on the hard disk and how to use the unregistered version of any software like this.

John

Via e-mail

digit

Dear John,

Software companies provide trial software to allow you to make an informed buying decision, especially since the software could cost more than you would be willing to pay for.

It is not legal to use the trial software for more than the allowed period of time. Finding and removing the stored data to allow the software to run beyond the 30-day period is as bad as cracking the program itself to prevent it from looking at the data. We cannot help you do this.

Commentary on education

Hello,

Your article on computer education was both timely and judicious. I'd like to add my two cents to that piece: Although these institutes have the latest software versions, most of them are pirated. The institute provides a skills-oriented rather than a certificate-centric curriculum, so the use of original or pirated software just doesn't make a difference. Also the only difference between the faculty and the student is that the former joined the course a couple months before the latter, and is a few modules ahead. Coupled with the ambiguous and unregulated quality of the institutes themselves, you have a case where a student wants to gain a 'valid computer education', but has no idea what to do if and when he receives the certificate.

Natraj Jayaraman

Via e-mail



digit

Dear Natraj,

That's a good summary of what is wrong with our unorganised computer education system. That's why we need standards to be maintained by a government agency. In computer education though, that may be jumping from the frying pan into the fire. Our standards based B.E. syllabi are so far behind the times; it is amazing and gratifying, to see students do well despite them.

Hear the have-nots

Hi,

Looks like you guys are competing with the world's most popular software company, Microsoft! Every time MS releases an operating system, the demand for resources also goes up. So do the specifications of the Digit CD:

In October 2000: Windows 95/98, Internet Explorer 4.0/5.0+, Pentium 100 MHz, 16 MB of RAM. In April 2003: Win9x, Internet Explorer 5.0 upwards, Pentium 233 MHz, 64 MB of RAM. Do you guys think such resources are needed for just displaying the user interface?

Think of the lower-end systems that will have a problem and will not be able to get a clear idea as to what is stored inside the CD. OK, they can use the good old Windows Explorer to view the files, but many will not think of that!

I think a simple HTML interface (as you included in early 2001 CDs) will suffice, not Flash and Dreamweaver.

Karthik

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Karthik,

We move behind the times. The CD hardware and software requirements are all for products released 5 years ago. IE5 was available in 1998, as was the Pentium II processor. In three years, we moved the processor requirement up by only one generation, and to a speed 1/5th of the entry level desktops now available.

It is unreasonable to deprive the vast majority of our readers with decent hardware, of an interesting, lively experience. That said, we must also point out that there is no reason why the interface cannot function perfectly well on a Pentium 100 MHz. We deliberately avoid using the heavy, animation-rich Macromedia Director interface in favour of HTML and Flash that any machine running Windows 95 should be able to handle.

Playable games wanted

Dear Sir,

Funzone was started to cater to people with older low-end machines as also to give some games which children could enjoy. I've noticed that almost all the games featured in Funzone are now trial versions and also require the latest software drivers, etc to play. Could you revert to featuring few low-end, freeware games that small children in age group 5 to 7 years find easy to play? This way they will be interested in computers, and they too would gain from Digit.

Jaggi

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Jaggi,

You are right about the intent of the section and we have indeed drifted a little from that mission. However, it is also a fact that though the games may be suited for younger audiences, or may have low hardware requirements, they will require driver updates. This is because when developers write new games, they use the latest software available. Beyond a point, we would have to resort to carrying software of historic interest to avoid driver updates. But rest assured, we will try to minimise any such inconveniences to you in the near future.

digit READERPOLLS

Q. Which anti-virus software do you use?

Norton	McAfee	AVG	PC Cillin
30.6 %	43 %	20.3 %	6 %

Clearly we need to carry regular updates for the Norton and McAfee anti-virus solutions

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Question: What would you like to see on the Mindware CD? Choice of Answers (for Web site only)

☐ Business Software ☐ Utilities ☐ White papers / E-books

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote